

Standard Operating Procedure

DVT Risk Assessment and Prophylaxis

«Hospital Name» — Supports COP.16.d (Stop-Work)

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» identifies patients at risk of deep vein thrombosis and manages that risk using a validated assessment tool.

2. Scope

Applies to every in-patient at admission, and every surgical patient pre-operatively.

3. Responsibility

Admitting Doctor / Ward Nurse: completes the DVT-risk assessment and implements the resulting management plan.

4. Procedure

1. Assess every patient's DVT risk using the hospital's adopted validated tool (e.g. Caprini Risk Assessment Model).
2. Document the tool used and the resulting risk level.
3. For patients found at risk, implement management per written guidance — mechanical prophylaxis (compression stockings, intermittent pneumatic compression) and/or pharmacological prophylaxis, as clinically indicated.
4. Reassess on any significant change in mobility or surgical status.

5. Stop-Work Authority

Do not use a non-validated or informal method as a substitute for the adopted DVT-risk tool.

Do not leave a patient identified as high DVT risk without the defined prophylaxis in place.

Raising a missed or overdue DVT-risk assessment is not a disciplinary matter.

6. Records

Supported by Record 5 of the COP.16 Required Records pack: DVT Risk Assessment Record.

7. Related Documents

- HCO_COP_16_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — COP.16 policy

8. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any hospital-acquired VTE event.

9. References

- Caprini, J. A. (2005). Thrombosis risk assessment as a guide to quality patient care. *Disease-a-Month*, 51(2-3), 70-78. <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/15900257/> — describes the Caprini Risk Assessment Model, the hospital's adopted example tool, validated across an estimated 5 million patients internationally.